



Go Flat Out

LCD monitors have gained in popularity across the world but are yet to catch on in India. Will 2005 be their year?

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Let's begin with the basics. LCD displays utilise two sheets of polarising material with a liquid crystal solution between them. An electric current passed through the liquid causes the crystals to align so that light cannot pass through them. Each crystal, therefore, is like a shutter, either allowing light to pass through or blocking the light.

Since computers made their way into our homes and offices, CRT (Cathode Ray Tube) displays have been the norm. In fact, even today in India, they remain the top choice. Can Liquid Crystal Display (LCD) monitors that have grown in popularity across the world take a foothold in India?

Those With It

The gaming community has driven, to a large extent, recent advances in personal computing, and most high-end

consumer components today are targeted at gamers. LCD monitors became a hot commodity due to the slim profile and light weight, making them ideal for carrying and transport. However, one of the longest issues dodging LCD monitors is their inability to achieve a low latency, fast pixel response time, which is responsible for the ghosting effect.

CRT monitors have a sub-1 millisecond response time, and that's why there has been a slower adoption of LCDs for entertainment and gaming purposes. LCD panels with 12ms refresh rate have just begun to take over as the performance models, and manufacturers have already announced their 8ms line-ups. BenQ seems to have beaten the competition as they debuted, in November 2004, the world's first 8ms LCD monitor.

Says LG India's Deputy GM (Sales and Marketing), IT Products, R Manikandan, "LCDs will never replace CRT monitors in a price-sensitive market like India. When CRTs are available at half the cost of the LCD, it will take some time for the latter to make inroads into the home segment."

Hot Or Not?

It has been four years since LCD panels entered the mainstream computer display

